

iPad prices drop

Apple has just dropped its refurbished iPad & iPad2 prices by between \$20 and \$50
<http://dgit.in/JOXJvQ>



Motion control takes a 'leap'

'Leap Motion' has started taking pre-orders for its \$70 USB peripheral. Have a look at this awesome video <http://dgit.in/JoMPzb>

HDMI out, it does support a full USB port and has a good capacitive touchscreen.

Last but not least, we have the Wishtel Ira Thing tablet. Yes, the name of the device is "Thing". It has a resistive touchscreen and does come with a stylus. Experience isn't great.

All the tablets are at par when it comes to the build and specifications on paper with the difference not being much. The PlayBook has the highest internal storage with 16GB bit lacks any means to expand it.

FEATURES AND PERFORMANCE

Spread all 15 tablets out on a table and they may look similar to you. Most of them even have similar hardware and processor clock speeds under the hood. But the distinguishing factor is the OS.

IBERRY AUXUS AX02

For starters, its well built and has a good overall feel to it. It fits well in our hands nonetheless. The OS runs silky smooth and the overall benchmark performance was top notch. It felt like the perfect marriage between hardware and the latest software, topping our comparison test's charts for the best performance score.

It comes with a bunch of preloaded apps such as the GetJar app store, full Office Suite and Aldiko reader. There was no stutter when we played the 1080p videos and the sound from the speakers was good. Angry birds loaded quickly enough and ran smoothly too.

MICROMAX FUNBOOK

The Funbook is the cheapest ICS tablet on our list but don't link the price to its performance. It

has a 1.2GHz processor, 512MB RAM and the ARM Mali-400M GPU which is the same we have come to love from the Samsung Galaxy S2. The device was neck on neck with the iBerry in terms of benchmark performance and even surpassed it in some cases.

The Funbook also comes preloaded with a bunch of apps such as Documents to go, E-learning, Live TV and Micromax's own app store called the Mstore, in addition to the Google Play Store.

Where the device loses out though is in the performance of its display and the battery backup. The performance of



iBerry Auxus AX02

the keyboard and the overall touchscreen falls a bit short when compared to the competition. This device is however a bang for the buck if you want a cheap Android tablet that can support all the latest goodies.

RELIANCE 3G TAB

The Reliance 3G tab is one that contradicts itself. The benchmark scores were underwhelming, but its real life usage performance was

impressive. The device has touch sensitive keys to represent home, menu and back and it the only Android 2.3 tablet on the list with the ability to make calls.

The biggest advantage of this tablet is that you can access 3G via the SIM card and doesn't need a USB dongle hanging from the side, as you would have with the other devices. However, this is locked to the Reliance GSM network.

IBALL SLIDE

This tablet blew us away from the moment it left the box. The design has completely changed from the version we tested last year, it has become cooler, sexier and better performing.

The tablet is very comfortable to hold in both landscape and portrait mode, although the keyboard could have been better. The audio-video playback on this device was the best amongst all. The interface of the device is very smooth.

The tablet is an all rounder as its performance is smooth hardware is good and it can run apps from Google Play Store. This tablet wins an award as you'll find out later in the article.

INTEX ITAB

The Intex iTab has the largest screen we have seen in this category. Not only is the size of the screen 8 inches, but its aspect ratio is 4:3 making it stand out. The larger screen gives you more space to work in and this is really good for the keyboard in both portrait and landscape mode. The device too comes with Android 2.3 skinned to



Micromax Funbook

portray Android 4.0. One disadvantage of the device is that its aspect ratio leads to loss of screen real estate.

ZYNC Z909 PLUS

A sibling to the Z990, the Z 909 Plus has the specs right on paper but is flawed in its execution. For starters, the touchscreen is resistive making it a bit cumbersome to work on.

The device did run the games and 1080p videos but the experience was a bit underwhelming – would freeze when we jumped around on the playback timeline. Slinging Angry Birds across the screen wasn't fun – lacked the fluidity of better displays. In terms of benchmarks too the device was an underperformer. It has the second lowest benchmark scores of all the tablets we tested. Of course, the tablet is the cheapest on our



Zync Z990